

NurturePath Lactation Services

Latch Troubleshooting & Positions

Achieving a Comfortable, Effective Feed

Signs of a Good Latch A deep, effective latch is the key to pain-free nursing and efficient milk transfer. Look and listen for these signs:

- Your baby's mouth is opened very wide (like a yawn).
- Both the top and bottom lips are flanged outward (like fish lips).
- Your baby's chin is pressed deeply into your breast, with their nose slightly free.
- You hear rhythmic swallowing (a soft "k" sound) rather than clicking or smacking.

Signs of a Poor Latch

- Nursing is acutely painful beyond the first few seconds of initial suction.
- Your nipple comes out looking flattened, creased, or shaped like a fresh tube of lipstick.
- Your baby frequently slips off the breast or seems frustrated.

Try a New Position Sometimes, simply shifting how you hold your baby can fix a shallow latch:

- **Cross-Cradle Hold:** Excellent for newborns. Use your arm opposite the breast you are feeding from to support the baby's back and neck, leaving your other hand free to shape the breast.
- **Football Hold:** Great for mothers recovering from C-sections or those with larger breasts. Tuck your baby under your arm (like a football) with their legs pointing toward your back.
- **Laid-Back Nursing:** Recline on a sofa or bed and let your baby rest on your chest. Gravity helps the baby anchor deeply onto the breast, utilizing their natural reflexes.